E-commerce Seller Analytics

Design Brief

Project Background

Small e-commerce business owners rely on sales and product data to make informed decisions. However, important business information is often scattered across different platforms, spreadsheets, or simply are not easily accessible. Existing analytics dashboards are more inclined to fit big companies and businesses. Existing dashboards can also be complex and overwhelming, especially for users with limited data analytics experience.

Problem Statement

Small e-commerce business owners struggle to get a clear understanding of their business performance due to scattered data, complex dashboards, and difficulty identifying product trends. Without clear, actionable insights, they may find it challenging to make timely, data-driven business decisions.

Target Audience

Primary Users: Small e-commerce business owners who sell products online and have limited experience with data analytics.

Secondary Users: E-commerce marketplace managers who monitor seller performance, product trends, and overall marketplace activity.

Project Objectives

Design a simple, user-friendly e-commerce analytics dashboard that centralizes important business information, simplifies product performance tracking, and helps small business owners make informed decisions through clear, actionable insights.

- Understand the challenges users face when tracking and analyzing business performance.

- Identify essential sales and product performance metrics.
- Simplify complex data through intuitive navigation and clear visualizations.
- Help users recognize important trends and identify possible next actions.
- Design and test an interactive dashboard prototype in Figma.

Proposed Solution

A centralized e-commerce analytics dashboard that provides an overview of sales, product performance, and key business trends.

Key Features:

- Business overview with essential performance metrics.
- Product performance comparisons and rankings.
- Simple, easy-to-understand charts and filters.
- Actionable insights presented in plain language.

Project Stakeholders

UX Researcher (1) — My Role

- Plan and conduct user interviews.
- Identify user needs, pain points, and behaviors.
- Develop user personas, empathy maps, and journey maps.
- Analyze research findings to guide design decisions.

Full-Time Product Designer (1) — My Role

- Define the user experience and dashboard structure.
- Create user flows, wireframes, and UI designs in Figma.
- Develop an interactive prototype.
- Conduct usability testing and improve designs based on feedback.

Note: For this class project, I will take on both roles, managing the UX research and product design process from initial planning to the final prototype.

Project Deliverables

- UX research plan and interview findings.
- User personas, empathy maps, and journey maps.
- Problem statement and user flows.
- Low-fidelity wireframes.
- High-fidelity dashboard designs.
- Interactive Figma prototype.
- Usability testing findings and final design revisions.

Project Timeline

Phase	Activities	Deliverables	Assignees
Week 1 — Project Kickoff & Planning	Define project goals, problem, scope, and research approach	Design brief, initial research plan	UX Researcher, Product Designer
Week 2 — User Research	Conduct interviews and identify user needs	Interview notes, research findings	UX Researcher
Week 3 — Research Synthesis	Develop personas, empathy maps, and journey maps	User personas, empathy maps, journey maps	UX Researcher
Week 4 — Ideation & User Flows	Explore design solutions and map key tasks	User flows, initial sketches	Product Designer
Week 5 — Wireframing	Design dashboard layout and navigation	Low-fidelity Figma wireframes	Product Designer
Week 6 — UI Design & Prototyping	Refine interfaces and create interactions	High-fidelity screens, clickable prototype	Product Designer

Week 7 — Usability Testing	Test key tasks and collect feedback	Usability findings, prioritized improvements	UX Researcher, Product Designer
Week 8 — Final Refinement & Presentation	Improve designs and document outcomes	Final Figma prototype, UX case study/presentation	Product Designer

Project Constraints

- The project must be completed within the UX Fundamentals class timeline.
- Research participants may be limited to available small-business owners or individuals with relevant e-commerce experience.
- The prototype will use sample or simulated business data.
- The focus is on UX/UI design rather than developing a fully functional analytics system.

Communication Methods

- Weekly Class Meetings: Review project progress, receive instructor feedback, and discuss next steps during scheduled UX Fundamentals classes.
- Project Updates: Share progress, challenges, and deliverables with the instructor as required.
- Design Collaboration: Use Figma to organize wireframes, prototypes, and design feedback.
- Shared Documentation: Use Google Docs to maintain the design brief, research findings, and other project documentation.
- Shared Files: Figma URL and Google Docs URL (to be added).

Risks and Dependencies

- Limited Research Participants: Difficulty recruiting e-commerce sellers may affect the quality of user research.
- Time Constraints: The project must be completed within the UX Fundamentals class schedule.
- Limited User Feedback: Insufficient interview or usability testing feedback may lead to unvalidated design decisions.

- Data Availability: The prototype will depend on realistic sample data to demonstrate sales and product performance.
- Project Dependencies: User research and key findings should inform personas, wireframes, and prototype development.
- Instructor Feedback: Timely feedback is needed to guide design improvements before final submission.

Success Metrics

- Task Completion: At least 80% of test participants can successfully complete key tasks, such as identifying top-selling products.
- Error Reduction: Users make fewer navigation errors when locating important business information after design improvements.
- Efficiency: Users can find essential sales and product performance information within 1–2 minutes.
- User Satisfaction: At least 70% of participants rate the dashboard as easy to understand and navigate.
- Actionable Insights: At least 70% of participants can correctly identify an important sales trend and describe a reasonable next action.